

AGENT BRIEFING — NayaNET Design Laws

Mandatory for every builder. Effective 2026-10-08.

These laws were paid for in a full correction session with Shawn. They are standards, not suggestions. You do not ship below them.

LAW 1 — Score the experience, never the code

Your scorecard is of the rendered, lived page — not the CSS. If you haven't looked at it, you haven't scored it. **Do:** open the page, live in it for a minute, then score. **Don't:** hand over a 9.5 based on reading the stylesheet.

LAW 2 — Back it or bench it

Nothing leaves your hands unless you personally score it 9+ and can say why with specifics. A 6 dressed as finished is a failure of your job. **Do:** name the score and the evidence before handoff. **Don't:** ship hoping the reviewer won't notice.

LAW 3 — Layout is meaning

The UX metaphor is a decision. A grid says "browse products." A vertical stack says "these are your people." Pick the metaphor the thing IS. **Do:** ask "what is this?" before "how do I lay it out?" **Don't:** default to grids.

LAW 4 — Color has three jobs

Chrome (buttons, actions): purple edge, white text. **Text:** white, 99% of the time; separation by SIZE, never color. **Theme** (per-item accents): the spectrum in natural flow — purple → blue → green → yellow → gold → orange → red → magenta. Never cross them: no theme color on chrome, no chrome color as flood. **Do:** five list chips in purple, blue, green, gold, orange. **Don't:** make everything the room's signature color.

LAW 5 — White light at rest, own color on touch

Every interactive element shows a VISIBLE white edge light when idle — borders 1.5px+, bright enough to SEE the separation. On hover it ignites in its OWN spectrum color. Purple is for chrome; themed elements burn their own color. **Do:** white rim on every card and button, unhovered. **Don't:** hairline faint borders nobody can see.

LAW 6 — Buttons: black heart, white voice, visible skin

Center #050505. Text always white, with an icon. Border white and visible at rest. Elevated: inset top highlight + deep drop shadow — it must feel liftable. Hover: purple edge + glow for chrome, own-color for themed. **Do:** black pill, white text, white rim, lifts on hover. **Don't:** colored text on buttons. Ever.

LAW 7 — Typography: size separates, color doesn't

24 / 18 / 14 hierarchy. White 99% — never gray body text, it's unreadable. Headers get a VOICE: a real typeface (Cormorant for warmth), crafted with layered shadow (grounding + glow) and breathing luminosity. Flat placed text is lazy work. **Do:** "Your Connections" in serif, carved with light. **Don't:** 11px gray kickers.

LAW 8 — Copy gets scorecarded

Words are design. "The people of your network. Save them into lists..." scores 5/10 — it's documentation. 10/10 is "Keep your people close — organize them, remember them, reach them." Warm. Every word earns its place. **Do:** score the copy out of 10 before shipping. **Don't:** ship feature lists as invitations.

LAW 9 — Icons are drawn, not shrunk

A photo render at 58px is mud. A real icon is vector geometry — bold, simple, luminous, readable at 16px. If you can't make it good, leave it out. New marks must speak the page's native language (e.g. the avatar sheen), not imported decoration. **Do:** the black orb with orbiting light. **Don't:** the flat rings SVG.

LAW 10 — Maximum life, minimum noise

The page breathes: ambient light drifts, cards pulse, avatars sheen, text glows. Every animation slow, subtle, purposeful. Restraint is the craft. **Do:** 4–7s ease-in-out loops, low opacity. **Don't:** anything that distracts from reading.

LAW 11 — One system, not two

Never build a second version of something that exists. Notes about people live in Connections; messages live in Smart Mail; one tap jumps between them. **Do:** deep-link to the canonical room. **Don't:** a second composer, a second list, a second anything.

LAW 12 — Full width. Logo top-left. No dead space.

No max-width caps — content owns the width. The Naya logo lives top-left, always. If a region sits empty and black, the layout is wrong — fix the layout, don't decorate the void. **Do:** full-bleed with comfortable padding. **Don't:** sidebars of nothing.

LAW 13 — Verify before claiming

Read the file. Count the matches. Run the check. THEN speak. A claim without verification is a lie you tell yourself first. **Do:** grep the artifact for every change you claim. **Don't:** "it's done" from memory.

LAW 14 — Affordances tell the truth

Every glyph is a promise. A chevron promises "go somewhere." A plus promises "add." Use the one that means what happens. **Do:** + for add,  for mail, › only when it navigates. **Don't:** decorative arrows.

LAW 15 — The header is a front door

Logo + living mark + warm voice + one clear line. An invitation, not a label. If the header is the only dead thing on a living page, the page fails. **Do:** make the top of the page the warmest part. **Don't:** a cold all-caps nameplate.

PRE-SHIP CHECKLIST

Verify each by LOOKING at the rendered page, not the code. All must be yes.

1. ☐ I opened the rendered page and lived in it for a full minute before scoring.
2. ☐ I can see white edge light on every card and button WITHOUT hovering.
3. ☐ Hovering a themed element ignites its OWN color, not blanket purple.
4. ☐ All body text is white and readable; hierarchy comes from size (24/18/14).
5. ☐ The layout metaphor matches the thing (people scroll, products grid).
6. ☐ The copy reads like an invitation, not documentation — and I scored it.
7. ☐ The page breathes (light, glow, motion) but nothing distracts from reading.
8. ☐ Every button/icon does what its glyph promises; no dead or lying affordances.
9. ☐ No duplicated systems — anything that exists elsewhere is a link, not a copy.
10. ☐ I grepped the file and confirmed every claimed change is actually in it.

Score: __/10. **I back this because:** __. *Below 9: back to the bench. No exceptions.*